

A Letter Concerning the Crown of Burned Names, Sent Under a Sealed Hand

To the Warden of Greythrone,

I place this warning before you because the tongue is a treacherous vessel, and the written word may yet be burned without wholly vanishing.

The relic called **The Crown of Burned Names** is no mere circlet for the brow. It is a ward forged in **266 AS**, and its attunement cost is **60**. I record those figures plainly, though I distrust all plainness where this object is concerned. Its identity rests upon the tension between protection and the erasure carried by burned names. Thus it may preserve the bearer while diminishing what the bearer was called, or what others were permitted to remember. I cannot say which loss comes first. The Crown offers no answer, only silence.

In appearance, it is a crown of blackened, name-scarred material, stark in its funerary silhouette. Even at rest it imposes a hushed atmosphere of remembrance, loss, and guarded identity. Those who stand near it lower their voices. Those who look upon it seem to search their own memories for a door that has already been sealed. I advise that no oath be spoken over it unless every word has first been weighed. Names are not harmless things beneath such a shadow.

As for **Greythrone**, remember what can be proven and what cannot. Greythrone was founded in **313 AS** in the **Gloaming Reach**. It is contested, garrisoned by **4,672 troops**, and lies outside the realm's core holdings. Its visual identity is that of a grey, throne-like stronghold rising from the Gloaming Reach. Its demeanor is tense and embattled, with authority under constant challenge. A fortress may possess walls, soldiers, and banners, yet still fail to possess obedience. I have seen enough of stone to know this.

Should The Crown of Burned Names be brought within Greythrone, keep it guarded from ceremony, curiosity, and every hand that believes protection is free. Do not mistake its funerary silence for peace. Do not mistake the erasure it carries for mercy. If the Crown shields a name, ask what must be surrendered for the shield to hold. If it burns a name, ask who benefits from the empty place.

I send no command, only this burden of caution. In the Ashen Era, that is often the nearest thing left to wisdom.

Under ash and sealed remembrance,

The undersigned